

Fancy That!

A spot of strategy with your Afternoon Tea

2-4 Players

Ages 10+

45-60 Minutes

The Story

The afternoon tea trolley has arrived, and the display is magnificent. Sweeping tiers of fondant fancies, tartes, pavlovas, and gâteaux glisten under warm light. But there are only so many to go around - and you are not the only one with an eye on the éclair.

In *Fancy That!*, players sweep coloured tiles from a shared market, arrange them into patterns on their personal boards, and claim patisserie reward cards. But serving costs you: every claim breaks a pattern you just built, blocks a cell of your board forever, and sends one tile to your cake stand - a tiered display where each row locks to a single flavour.

Five flavours, four rows: one flavour is always off the menu.

Build the finest display, and the day is yours. Fancy that!



- 100 tiles (5 colours × 5 ingredient symbols × 4 copies each)
- 50 reward cards
- 4 Fresh Pot of Tea cards
- 4 personal player boards (5×5 grid)
- 4 cake stand boards (one per player)
- 1 central market board (6×6 grid, with 4 printed cupcake symbols)
- 1 drawstring tile bag
- 32 tart tokens
- 16 cupcake tokens

The Tiles

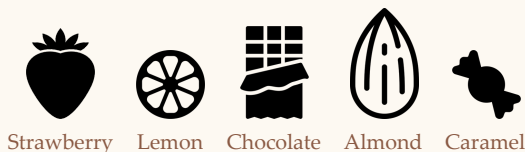
Every tile has two properties, and each drives a different part of the game.

Colour is the claiming currency. There are five colours. Colour is all that matters when you build patterns and claim reward cards.



Ingredient symbol is the scoring currency.

Ingredients only matter on your cake stand, where each row locks to a single ingredient.



Every colour appears with every symbol. The two never mix: no rule ever changes a tile's ingredient, and ingredients never affect which cards you can claim. The one place the two currencies meet is the sweep - declare a *colour* to build toward claims, or declare an *ingredient* to stock your stand.

The Reward Cards

Each reward card shows:

- A patisserie illustration
- A **colour pattern** (1–4 coloured tile squares arranged in a small shape)
- A **victory point (VP)** value

Rotation rule

Any pattern may be matched in any rotation or reflection on your board.

Cards discarded during the game form a face-down discard pile. If the deck ever runs out, shuffle the discard pile to form a new deck.

The Fresh Pot of Tea Cards

Each player is dealt one Fresh Pot of Tea card at setup. Playing it refreshes the whole trolley - the card market *and* the tile market - once per game. Keep it in front of you as a reminder; an unused Tea card is worth nothing at the end of the game. See **Order a Fresh Pot of Tea**.

Setup

1. Shuffle the 50-card deck. Place the top 4 cards face-up in a row - this is the **card market**.
2. Place all 100 tiles in the bag. Draw tiles and fill every cell of the market board. In a 2-player game, use only the marked 5×5 inner area; with 3 or 4 players, use the full 6×6 grid.
3. Each player takes a personal 5×5 board, a cake stand board, 2 cupcake tokens, and 1 Fresh Pot of Tea card, and clears a space beside their stand - this is their **crumb tray**.
4. Count out 8 tart tokens per player into a shared pool (e.g. 24 in a 3-player game). Return the rest to the box.
5. Randomly determine who goes first.

Playing the Game

your turn, step by step

Players take turns in clockwise order. On your turn, perform these steps in order. Before Step 1, you may play your **Fresh Pot of Tea card** (see next page); you then take your normal turn from Step 1.

Step 1 - Sweep

Choose any one row or column on the market board. Declare either a **colour** or an **ingredient symbol**. Take all tiles in that row or column that match your declaration. You must take at least one tile - if your chosen line has no matching tiles, choose again.

Bonus tile

If your sweep removes the very last tile from that row or column - completely clearing it - immediately take one additional tile from anywhere on the market board. You choose freely: any colour, any symbol. This bonus triggers at most once per turn; it does not chain.

An empty trolley?

If the market board is completely empty at the start of your turn, refill it: draw from the bag and fill every cell, then sweep as normal. No cupcakes are gained this way - see Order a Fresh Pot of Tea.

Step 2 - Place Tiles

Place all tiles you just swept onto your personal 5×5 board, in any empty cells - there is no adjacency

requirement. You must place all swept tiles this turn; you may not hold tiles between turns.

If you cannot fit every swept tile on your board, place as many as you can and return the rest to the box - this triggers the end of the game (see End of the Game).

Step 3 - Claim (optional, max 1 per turn)

If tiles on your board form the colour pattern shown on any face-up card in the card market - or on your own **reserved card** (see The Personal Reserve) - in the correct shape and colours, in any rotation or reflection, you may claim it:

1. **Remove exactly one tile** from the tiles that formed the matching pattern. You choose which.
2. **Place a tart token** in the vacated cell. That cell is permanently blocked for the rest of the game.
3. **Plate the removed tile** - place it immediately onto your cake stand or into your crumb tray (see The Cake Stand).
4. **Take the card** and place it face-up beside your board.
5. **Refill the card market** by drawing the top card of the deck face-up, returning the market to 4 cards.

The remaining tiles of the matched pattern stay on your board. You may only claim one card per turn, even if multiple patterns are complete.

Worked example - the sweep

Declare "Pink!"



Take both pink tiles - whatever their ingredients. Colour sweeps build card patterns.

...or declare "Strawberry!"



The same line, swept differently: take both strawberry tiles - whatever their colours. Ingredient sweeps stock your cake stand.

Worked example - the claim

1 · Match



Three tiles match the card's pattern - any rotation or reflection.

2 · Serve



Remove **one** matched tile; tart its cell forever. The rest stays.

3 · Plate



Plate it to a stand row (locking it to Strawberry) or the crumb tray. Take the card; refill the market.

Order a Fresh Pot of Tea!

before Step 1 • once per game

At the start of your turn, before sweeping, you may play your Fresh Pot of Tea card. Call it out: “Order a fresh pot of tea!” The trolley returns to the kitchen and comes back fully restocked. Then:

1. **Reserve round** - starting with you and going clockwise, each player may reserve 1 card from the card market, placing it face-up beside their board (see The Personal Reserve). Players with a full reserve pass.
2. **Flush the trolley** - discard all unreserved market cards to the discard pile and deal 4 new cards from the deck.
3. **Take the cupcake reward** - gain 1 cupcake token for each cupcake symbol visible on an empty cell of the tile market.
4. **Refill the tiles** - draw from the bag and fill every empty cell of the market board. If the bag runs dry, fill what you can.
5. **Discard your Tea card** - it is spent for the game.

Then take your normal turn from Step 1: sweep from the fresh market, place, and optionally claim - including a card you just reserved.



The Fresh Pot of Tea card - each player has one.

When should you order?

The longer the table waits, the emptier the market grows - and the more cupcake symbols are showing. Fire early for a small reward and first pick of a fresh trolley, or wait for a bigger reward and risk someone beating you to it.

The Personal Reserve

- You may hold a **maximum of 1 reserved card**. If your reserve is full, you pass during tea rounds.
- Reserved cards sit **face-up** beside your board - everyone can see them, and no other player can claim them.
- Claiming your reserved card is a normal claim in every respect, except it does not refill the card market.
- An uncompleted reserved card scores 0 at the end of the game. There is no penalty.

Cupcake Tokens

Cupcakes are the game’s flexibility currency - one token, three ways to use it:

Use it to...	When
Move a tile already on your board to any empty cell of your board	any time on your turn
Move a tart token on your board to any empty cell of your board	any time on your turn
Keep it: worth 1 point	end of the game

You start with 2 cupcakes. You gain more from the **cupcake reward** when you play your Tea card, and from plating onto **cupcake plates**. There is no limit to how many you may hold. Spent cupcakes return to the supply.

Tiles already plated on your cake stand can never be moved - no cupcake use reaches them.



The cake stand board. Cupcake icons mark bonus plates; numbers are running totals.

- When you claim a card, the tile you remove from your board goes **immediately** to one of:
- the **next empty plate of any one row** of your cake stand (rows fill left to right), provided that row is empty or already holds tiles of the **same ingredient symbol** - and, if the row is empty, that no other row already holds that ingredient; or
 - your **crumb tray**.

The first tile placed on a row sets that row's ingredient for the rest of the game, and an ingredient may only ever appear on one row. Once a row is full, further tiles of its ingredient can only go to the crumb tray. Once placed, tiles never move - plating is permanent.

The crumb tray is always a free choice. You may send a tile there even when a legal plate is available - typically to avoid locking a row to an ingredient you don't want. Each crumb tray tile is worth 1 point at the end of the game.

Five ingredients, four rows: one flavour is always off the menu. Which flavour you abandon, and when each row locks, is the heart of your display.

Plate Values

Each plate shows its row's **running total** - a row is always worth the value printed beneath its **last filled plate**. Each tile you add to a row is worth more than the last:

Row	Plates	Running totals
Top	1	5
Third	2	4 / 9
Second	3	3 / 7 / 12
Bottom	4	2 / 6 / 14 / 26

Short rows are safe but small; the bottom row starts slow and finishes with the biggest moves in the game. Spread your first tiles across four rows and they are worth 14; fill the bottom row with one flavour and it alone is worth 26.

Cupcake plates

Four plates print a cupcake icon: the **second plate of each multi-plate row**, and the **top row's single plate**. Whenever you plate a tile onto a cupcake plate, immediately gain 1 cupcake token from the supply. An uncovered icon means the bonus is still available.

End of the Game

last one at the trolley...

The game ends when **the last tart token is placed** from the shared pool. Complete the current round so that every player has had an equal number of turns, then proceed to scoring. The dwindling tart pool is the game's clock - keep an eye on it.

The game also ends **immediately** if a player's board is completely full of tiles and tarts at the start of their turn - score at once. If a sweep gives a player more tiles than they have space to place, they place as many as they can and return the rest to the box; the game then ends after every other player has taken exactly one more turn.

Scoring

Add up:

- **Each row of your cake stand:** the value printed beneath its last filled plate (an empty row scores 0)
- **Each crumb tray tile:** 1 point
- **Each claimed reward card:** its printed VP value (completed reserved cards included)
- **Each unspent cupcake:** 1 point

An uncompleted reserved card scores 0. An unused Fresh Pot of Tea card scores 0.

The highest score wins.

Tiebreaker

The tied player who claimed the most reward cards wins (completed reserved cards count). If still tied, share the victory.

Scoring example

Your bottom row holds 4 Almond tiles **(26)**. Your second row holds 2 Caramel tiles **(7)**. Your third row holds 1 Lemon tile **(4)**. Your top row is empty **(0)**.

Two tiles sit in your crumb tray **(2)**. Your six claimed cards print 4+5+2+6+3+5 **(25)**. You kept one cupcake **(1)**.

Total: 65 points.

Quick Reference

1. **Tea?** Before sweeping, you may play your Fresh Pot of Tea card: reserve round, flush, cupcake reward, refill tiles.
2. **Sweep** a row or column, declaring a colour or an ingredient. Cleared the line? Bonus tile.
3. **Place** every swept tile in empty cells of your board.
4. **Claim** (optional, max 1): match a pattern, remove one tile, tart the cell, plate the tile, take the card, refill the market.

Pinkies up. Play nicely. Leave no fancy behind.

